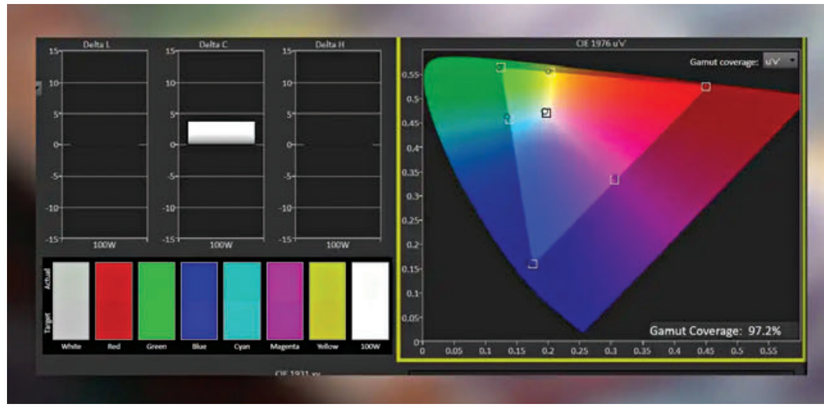
Another thing to check is uniformity. When you open a plain white or grey screen, look carefully at all corners. If you notice yellow patches or darker zones, the display is not evenly lit. This is a common issue on cheaper laptop panels and can sometimes be visible even on mid-range models.

The best part is that this entire test takes less than ten minutes. It gives you a detailed sense of how much colour accuracy you can realistically expect from your laptop.



Trick 2: Test viewing angles and backlight performance

Numbers are helpful, but nothing beats real-world scenarios. After all, you do not use gradients and colour bars in your daily life. You watch videos, play games, scroll through social feeds, and browse the web. This means that you can use real-world content to check two major qualities that define a good laptop screen: viewing angles and backlight glow.

Start with a high-resolution photo. Ideally, something with a mix of bright colours, dark shadows, and lots of detail. Nature photos are perfect. Think colourful birds, sunsets or cityscapes. Now tilt the laptop slightly up and down. Look at it from the side and while sitting slightly off centre.

A good display should maintain colours and brightness no matter where you look at it from. The picture should not look dull when viewed from an angle. The colours should not invert or shift. Blacks should not turn grey. If they do, your display likely uses a TN panel or a lower-quality IPS panel.

Next, play a dark movie scene. Something like a night chase or a horror shot with lots of shadows. Dim the lights. This is where you can spot backlight bleeding, glow, or uneven brightness. If you see bright patches around the edges, especially in the corners, that is backlight bleed. If the sides look hazy in dark scenes, that is IPS glow.

They aren't deal breakers, but they tell you how well your display handles darker content. If you watch thrillers, horror, or documentaries, these issues are hard to ignore. They ruin the mood and lower the contrast.

You can also test motion handling. Play a fast action clip or gaming montage. Pause any moment, then move forward frame by frame. If you see ghosting trails or smudges around moving objects, your display response time is average. This is important for gaming laptops. Even a beautiful colour-accurate screen fails if the motion blur is too heavy.

Another fun test involves scrolling text. Open a simple website with a lot of text and scroll fast. If the text smears, the display has slow response times. If the text remains sharp while scrolling, it is performing well.

This trick helps you understand not just how the laptop performs on paper, but how it feels in day-to-day use. And that difference is often huge.

Trick 3: Use online benchmark tools

This is where things get slightly nerdy but still very user-friendly. There are various online tools designed specifically to put your screen through scientific tests. And no, you do not need technical skills to run these benchmarks. The tools run automatically and guide you through each step.

One of the simplest tests checks pixel density. Many people buy Full HD laptops and assume they are sharp enough. But a 1080p screen on a 14-inch laptop looks different from the same resolution on a 16-inch laptop.

True HDR laptops are still very rare. Many models advertise HDR playback, but only support certain formats or work well only in controlled environments. Online tests show you whether your laptop can hit the brightness levels needed for real HDR content and if it can handle deeper blacks.

Do not worry even if your laptop fails HDR checks. Even many premium flagship machines struggle with proper HDR. However, it is good to know the limitations of your laptop, so you do not expect cinema-level visuals from a mid-range panel. d

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